Word Detective

Using context clues to work out new words

Grade 7 English Language · Miss S. Patterson

Start ›



What is a context clue?

A context clue is a hint in the words around a new word.

Good readers don't stop at a hard word. They look at the sentence, find the clue, and work out the meaning.

Try it

After the long race, Tia was **exhausted** and fell asleep on the bus.

Clue: a long race, then falling asleep. Exhausted means very tired.

Meet the 4 clues ›

Four kinds of clues

Tap each clue to open it. Then try the quick checks.



1 Definition

The sentence tells you the meaning.



2 Synonym

A word with the same meaning is nearby.



3 Antonym

A word with the opposite meaning is nearby.



4 Example

Examples show what the word means.

Quick checks ›

1 Definition clue

The hikers stopped at a **plateau**, which is a flat area of high land.

The words 'which is' give you the meaning straight away.



Signal words

is, means, which is, or, called

‹ Clue map



2 Synonym clue

Our classroom was **spotless**; in other words, it was very clean.

'Very clean' means the same as spotless.



Signal words

also, like, the same as, in other words

‹ Clue map



3 Antonym clue

Unlike her **timid** brother, Shanelle was bold and spoke up in class.

'Unlike' shows timid is the opposite of bold. Timid means shy.



Signal words

but, however, unlike, although, instead

‹ Clue map

4 Example clue

Jamaica grows many **citrus** fruits, such as oranges, limes, and grapefruit.

The examples are all sour, juicy fruits. That is what citrus means.



Signal words

such as, for example, including, like

‹ Clue map

Quick check 1 of 4

The doctor said Jordan had a **fracture**, which is a break in a bone.

What is a fracture?

- A deep cut
- A break in a bone
- A high fever

Tap your answer.

‹ Clue map

Job well done!

Yes! 'Which is' gave you the meaning.



Next question ›

Quick check 2 of 4

The road to Port Antonio was **narrow**; in other words, it was very thin.

What does narrow mean?

Thin

Wide

Long

Tap your answer.

‹ Clue map

Job well done!

Yes! 'Very thin' means the same as narrow.



Next question ›

Quick check 3 of 4

Unlike the noisy market, the church was **tranquil**.

What does tranquil mean?

- Crowded
- Loud
- Calm and quiet

Tap your answer.

‹ Clue map

Job well done!

Yes! 'Unlike the noisy market' shows tranquil is the opposite: calm.



Next question ›

Quick check 4 of 4

At the fair, we ate many **delicacies**, such as fried fish, festival, and gizzada.

What are delicacies?

Special foods

Fun games

Cold drinks

Tap your answer.

‹ Clue map

Job well done!

Yes! Fried fish, festival, and gizzada are all special foods.



Finish ›

Case closed!

You're a word detective. Now use your skills.



Exit ticket: Write one sentence with a context clue for the word 'enormous'. Name the type of clue you used.



Back to the start ›

Not quite...

Try again! Look for the definition clue in the sentence.



Try again

Not quite...

Try again! Look for the synonym clue in the sentence.



Try again

Not quite...

Try again! Look for the antonym clue in the sentence.



Try again

Not quite...

Try again! Look for the example clue in the sentence.



Try again